INCH-POUND

A-A-50109A
October 29, 1993
SUPERSEDING
A-A-50109
April 10, 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

DISPENSERS, TABLEWARE, AUTOMATIC, SELF-LEVELING, MOBILE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Model A dispensers of MIL-D-40631. For specific classification of items listed in this document, see 5.5.

1. ABSTRACT

1.1 Abstract. This commercial item description covers mobile self-leveling, automatic, tableware dispensers in the following types, designs, styles, and sizes as specified (see 5.2):

Type I - Heated dish dispenser

Design A - Enclosed cabinet (see figure 1)
Design B - Open tubular frame (see figure 2)

Style 2 - Two dispensing units
Size 5 - 5-5/8 inch diameter bowls
Size 9 - 9 inch diameter plates

Style 3 - Three dispensing units
Size 7 - 6-3/4 inch diameter plates

Style 4 - Four dispensing units
Size 5 - 5-5/8 inch diameter bowls
Size 9 - 9 inch diameter plates

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Commander, U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: SATNC-WEE, Natick, MA 01760-5018.

AMSC N/A FSC 7320

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Type II - Cup, tumbler, and bowl dispenser, unheated

Design B - Open, tubular frame (see figure 3)
Design C - Cantilevered carrier (see figure 4)

Size 1 - 16 inch by 16 inch racks
Size 2 - 20 inch by 20 inch racks

Type III - Tray dispenser, unheated

Design B - Open tubular frame (see figure 5)
Design C - Cantilevered carrier (see figure 6)

Size 1 - 15-1/4 by 20-1/4 inch tray
Size 3 - 14 inch by 18 inch tray
Size 4 - 12 inch by 16 inch tray

Type IV - Cup and saucer dispenser, unheated

Design B - Open tubular frame (see figure 7)
Design D - Enclosed column with cantilevered carrier (see figure 8)

Style 2 - Two saucer dispensing units

Type V - Dish dispenser, unheated

Design A - Enclosed cabinet
Design B - Open tubular frame

Style 2 - Two dispensing units
Size 9 - 9 inch diameter plate

Style 3 - Three dispensing units
Size 5 - 5-5/8 inch diameter soup or salad bowls

Style 4 - Four dispensing units
Size 5 - 5-5/8 inch diameter soup or salad bowls
Size 7 - 6-3/4 inch diameter plate
Size 9 - 9 inch diameter plate

1.2 CID based part identification number (PIN). A document based PIN to identify sizes of items is included in section 5. This identification numbering procedure is for Government purposes and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor except as information on "Government unique" data nameplates (see 5.4).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

2.1 General. Dispensers shall maintain the load of dishes, bowls, trays, or racks, as applicable, at the proper dispensing level. The self-leveling mechanism shall operate smoothly without binding and shall be accessible for adjustment to compensate for various loads. The adjustment shall be accomplished without addition, removal, or replacement of springs.

2.2 Material, design and construction. The dispensers shall be fabricated from stainless steel designed to the configuration shown in figures 1 through 8. Figures 1 through 8 are for illustrative purposes only and are not intended to exclude dispensers otherwise meeting all applicable requirements of this document. The overall height of all mobile dispensers shall be 37 ± 3 inches, except that mobile dispensers, with silverware holders shall have an overall height of 49 ± 3 inches. The dispensers shall be mounted on four 4 inch diameter (minimum) swivel casters, having a minimum load rating of 100 pounds each, two of which shall be equipped with brakes. Casters shall be removable. Dispensers shall be equipped with perimeter, corner, or round bumpers located so as to contact a vertical wall before any other portion of the dispenser and shall be removable in the event they become damaged and must be replaced.

2.3 Detail requirements.

2.3.1 Type I - Heated dish dispenser. The type I dispenser shall be designated to operate on a 120 volt, 60 hertz, single-phase power supply, or on a 220 volt, 50 hertz, single-phase power supply, as specified (see 5.2). The dispenser shall be designed to thermostatically maintain a free air temperature of 160°F ± 20°F within the fully loaded dispenser. The dispenser shall have a power switch and a power supply cord, and those designed for 120 volt, 60 hertz, single-phase power; except for style 4, size 9, shall be equipped with a National Electrical Manufacturers Association (NEMA) 5-15 P plug at the end of the cord. Style 4, size 9 units shall be equipped with NEMA 5-20 P plugs. The power supply cord shall be a standard 3-conductor type, a minimum of 5 foot long and grease and oil resistant. The dispensing mechanism shall be calibrated to dispense the number and types of bowls and plates specified below:

	Size 5 (bowls)	Size 7 (plates)	Size 9 (plates)
No. of items (style 2)	56 min.	--	136 min.
No. of items (style 3)	--	216 min.	--
No. of items (style 4)	112 min.	--	272 min.
Diameter	5-5/8 ± 1/16 in.	6-3/4 ± 1/16 in.	9 ± 1/16 in.
Height of 1 item	2-1/8 inches	1 inch	31/32 inches
Height of 11 items, stacked	10-1/2 inches	3-1/2 inches	4 inches
Weight of 10 items	8-3/4 pounds	7 pounds	13-3/4 pounds

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.3.2 Type II - Cup, tumbler; and bowl dispenser, unheated. The type II dispenser shall be designed to dispense cups, tumblers, or bowls from racks. The dispenser shall have a minimum capacity of six loaded racks, with the top rack at approximately the normal dispensing height. The dispensing mechanism shall be calibrated to dispense racks that are 5 inches high and weigh 17 pounds loaded. When specified, type II dispensers shall be equipped with silverware holders firmly assembled to the units (see 5.2). The holders shall have a minimum of eight removable cylindrical silverware containers. The holders, when mounted on the dispenser, shall not increase the height of the unit by more than 12 inches and shall not protrude beyond the width or depth of the unit.

2.3.3 Type III - Tray dispenser, unheated. The type III dispenser shall be designed to dispense trays. The dispensing mechanism shall be calibrated to dispense the number and type of trays specified below:

	Size 1	Size 3	Size 4
No. of trays	80 min.	80 min.	100 min.
Tray size	15-1/4 by 20-1/2 in.	14 by 18 in.	12 by 16 in.
Height of 1 tray	7/8 inch	7/8 inch	1-1/8 inches
Height of 11 trays, stacked	4 inches	4 inches	3-5/8 inches
Weight of 10 trays	13.4 pounds	12.5 pounds	14.1 pounds

When specified, type III dispensers shall be equipped with silverware holders firmly assembled to the units (see 5.2). The silverware holder shall have a minimum of eight removable cylindrical silverware containers. The holders, when mounted on the dispenser, shall not increase the height of the unit by more than 12 inches and shall not protrude beyond the width or depth of the unit.

2.3.4 Type IV - Cup and saucer dispenser, unheated. The type IV dispensers shall be designed to dispense both cups from racks and saucers from two dispensing tubes. The dispensing mechanisms shall be calibrated to dispense the number and type of saucers and loaded racks as specified below:

	Saucers	Racks
No. of items	116 minimum	6 minimum
Item size	5-7/8 inches diameter	20 by 20 inches
Height of 1 item	1 inch	5 inches
Weight of 1 item	---	14-1/2 pounds
Height of 11 items, stacked	5 inches	---
Weight of 10 items	5.09 pounds	---

2.3.5 Type V - Dish dispenser, unheated. The type V dispenser shall be similar to figures 1 and 2 but uninsulated and unheated. The dispensing mechanism shall be calibrated to dispense the number and type of bowls and plates specified below:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

	Size 5 (bowls)	Size 7 (plates)	Size 9 (plates)
No. of items (style 2)	--	--	136 min.
No. of items (style 3)	84 min.	--	--
No. of items (style 4)	112 min.	288 min.	272 min.
Diameter	5-5/8 inches	6-3/4 inches	9 inches
Height of 1 item	2-1/8 inches	1 inch	31/32 inches
Height of 11 items, stacked	10-1/2 inches	3-1/2 inches	4 inches
Weight of 10 items	8-3/4 pounds	7 pounds	13-3/4 pounds

2.4 Standard compliance. The type I dispensers shall comply with the applicable provisions of UL 197 and NSF International Standard No. 2. The type II, III, IV, and V dispensers shall conform to the applicable requirements of NSF International Standard No. 2.

2.5 Data nameplate ("Government unique" requirement). The dispenser shall be furnished with a data nameplate in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-STD-130 except the requirements for: (a) Methods of applying, (b) Identification tags, (c) Information not required, and (d) Optional marking information shall not apply. The data nameplate shall be made of minimum 20 gauge corrosion-resisting metal and attached to the dispenser by rivets, screws, or welding in such a manner as to meet the applicable NSF International sanitary requirements for this equipment. The plate shall contain the following information which shall be stamped, engraved, or applied by photosensitive means:

Contract Number
National Stock Number
Procurement Instrument Identification Number
CID Based Part Identification Number (PIN)
Manufacturer's Name, Address, and Telephone Number
Supplier's Name, Address, and Telephone Number (List Only if Different from Manufacturer)
Manufacturer's Model and Serial Number
Government Approved Manual Number

Each plate shall be placed so that it is readily visible to the operator during normal operating use and so as to not adversely affect the life and utility of the dispenser.

2.6 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, provided they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this commercial item description are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026l0-26T08:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

2.7 Regulatory requirements. In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable. The term "recovered materials" means materials which have been collected or recovered from solid waste and reprocessed to become a source of raw materials as opposed to virgin raw materials. None of the above shall be interpreted to mean that the use of used or rebuilt products are allowed under this commercial item description unless otherwise specified.

2.8 Workmanship. The finished dispensers shall be complete, clean, and free of fabrication marks, scratches, dents, sharp edges, sharp corners, burrs, slivers, or visible evidence of rust. Rivets, when used, shall be tight and the rivet heads and peened ends shall be round and concentric and in full contact with the joined metal surfaces. There shall be no empty rivet holes. Welds shall be clean, continuous, sound, and free of flux, pits, buildups, undercuts, and shall be ground so as to blend with the adjacent surfaces. Spot welds shall be free from pits, burn throughs, and flashes.

3. QUALITY ASSURANCE

3.1 Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics and requirements of this commercial item description and except for those Government unique requirements specified, conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace or that had successfully been delivered to the Government on a previous contract or purchase order. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

3.2 Compliance. Prior to approval of the first shipment, the contractor shall submit satisfactory evidence to the contracting officer or his authorized representative that the dispensers conforms to the requirements of UL Standard 197 (see 2.3.1), NEMA standards (see 2.3.1), and NSF International Standard No. 2 (see 2.4), as applicable.

3.2.1 Underwriters Laboratories, Inc. (UL). Acceptable evidence of meeting the requirements of UL Standard No. 197 shall be the UL listing mark, or a certified test report from a recognized independent laboratory acceptable to the Government indicating compliance with the applicable requirements of UL Standard 197.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026l0-26T08:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

3.2.2 NSF International. Acceptable evidence of meeting the requirements of NSF International Standards No. 2 or 4 shall be a listing in the current edition of the NSF International "Listing of Food Service Equipment" and display of the NSF International mark on the finished product, or a certified test report from a recognized independent laboratory acceptable to the Government indicating compliance with the applicable NSF International requirement(s).

3.2.3 National Electrical Manufacturers Association (NEMA). The contractor shall submit to the contracting officer a written certificate of compliance as proof that the tableware dispensers meet the applicable requirements of NEMA.

4. PACKAGING

4.1 Packaging and packing. Packaging and packing shall be commercial or export as specified (see 5.2).

4.2 Commercial. Each dispenser shall be cleaned, preserved, packaged, packed, and unitized in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

4.3 Export packaging. Each dispenser shall be disassembled to the extent determined by the contractor to protect parts susceptible to damage during shipment and storage. Disassembled parts shall be packaged in a fiberboard box conforming to type CF or SF, class domestic, style optional of PPP-B-636.

4.3.1 Export packing. Each dispenser with its packaged parts shall be packed in a nailed and lock-corner wood box conforming to class II, style 2, 4, or 7, type I load of PPP-B-621; or in a cleated plywood box conforming to domestic type, style optional of PPP-B-601. Each box shall be closed and reinforced in accordance with PPP-B-621 or PPP-B-601, as applicable.

4.3.2 Palletization. When specified, shipping containers shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147 (see 5.2).

4.4 Marking (commercial and export). Marking of unit packs, shipping containers, and palletized unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

5. NOTES

5.1 Intended use. The mobile tableware dispensers covered by this commercial item description is intended for use in dining facilities for dispensing dishes, bowls, trays, or racks.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
b. PIN designating type, design, style, and size required (see 1.1, 1.2, and 5.4).
c. Power supply required for type I dispenser (see 2.3.1).
d. When silverware holders are required (see 2.3.2 and 2.3.3).
e. Government approved manual number to be included on data nameplate (see 2.5).
f. Selection of applicable packaging and packing required (see 4.1).
g. When palletization is required (see 4.3.2).

5.3 Sources for documents.

5.3.1 Sources for non-Government association documents.

ASTM D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

ASTM documents are available from:

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM)
1916 Race Street
Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187

NEMA Standards are available from:

National Electrical Manufacturers Association (NEMA)
2101 L Street, NW
Washington, DC 20037

NSF International Standard No. 2 - Food Service Equipment
NSF International Standard No. 4 - Commercial Cooking and Hot Food Storage Equipment

NSF International documents are available from:

NSF International
3475 Plymouth Road
P.O. Box 130140
Ann Arbor, MI 48113-0140

UL Standard No. 197 - Commercial Electric Cooking Appliances

UL Standards are available from:

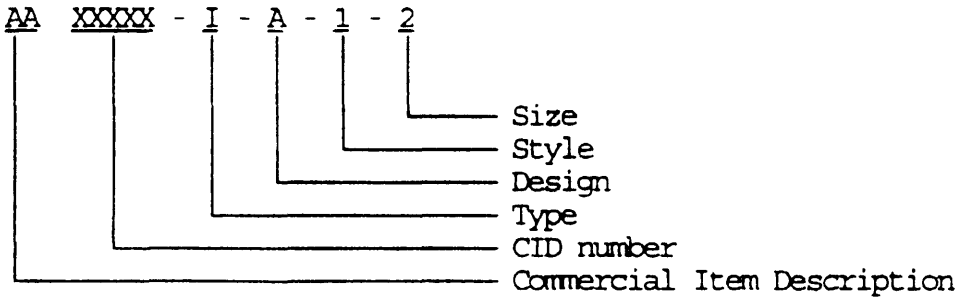
Underwriters Laboratories, Inc. (UL)
333 Pfingsten Road
Northbrook, IL 60062

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T08:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.3.2 Source for Government documents. Copies of military and federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

5.4 Part identification number (PIN). The PIN's to be used for items required by this CID are created as follows:



5.5 "Government unique" requirements. Whenever a "Government unique" requirement is included in the title of a paragraph under "Salient Characteristics", it is meant that the requirement is something that is not normally offered to the commercial marketplace by the manufacturer.

5.6 Supersession data. The types, designs, styles, and sizes of mobile tableware dispensers covered by this commercial item description replace items covered by MIL-D-40631 as indicated below:

CID-A-A-50109				MIL-D-40631				
Type	Design	Style	Size	Type	Design	Style	Size	Model
I	A or B	2	5	I	A or B	2	5	A
I	A or B	2	9	I	A or B	2	9	A
I	A or B	3	7	I	A or B	3	7	A
I	A or B	4	5	I	A or B	4	5	A
I	A or B	4	9	I	A or B	4	9	A
II	B or C	-	1	II	B or C	-	1	A
II	B or C	-	2	II	B or C	-	2	A
III	B or C	-	1	III	B or C	-	1	A
III	B or C	-	3	III	B or C	-	3	A
III	B or C	-	4	III	B or C	-	4	A
IV	B or D	2	-	IV	B or D	2	-	A

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CID-A-A-50109				MIL-D-40631				
Type	Design	Style	Size	Type	Design	Style	Size	Model
V	A or B	2	9	VI	A or B	2	9	A
V	A or B	3	5	VI	A or B	3	5	A
V	A or B	4	5	VI	A or B	4	5	A
V	A or B	4	7	VI	A or B	4	7	A
V	A or B	4	9	VI	A or B	4	9	A

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - YD
Air Force - 99

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50, 84
DLA - GS

User Activity

Navy - MC

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project 7320-0899

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026l0-26T08:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, ...

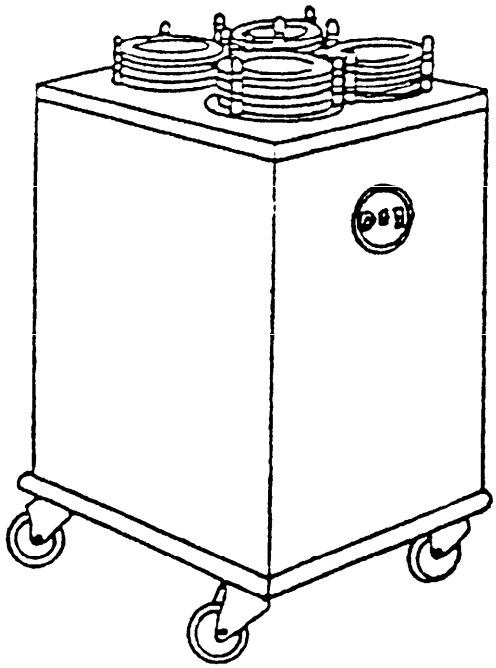


FIGURE 1. TYPE I, DESIGN A
(STYLE 4 SHOWN)

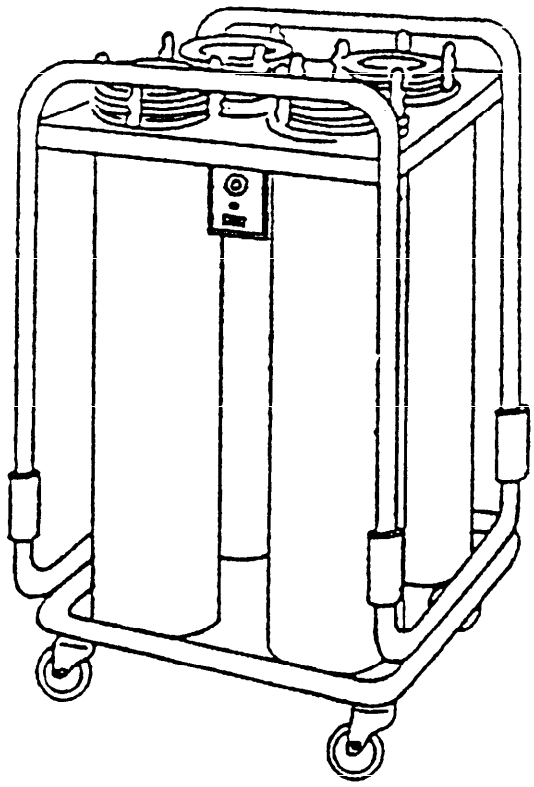


FIGURE 2. TYPE I, DESIGN B
(STYLE 4 SHOWN)

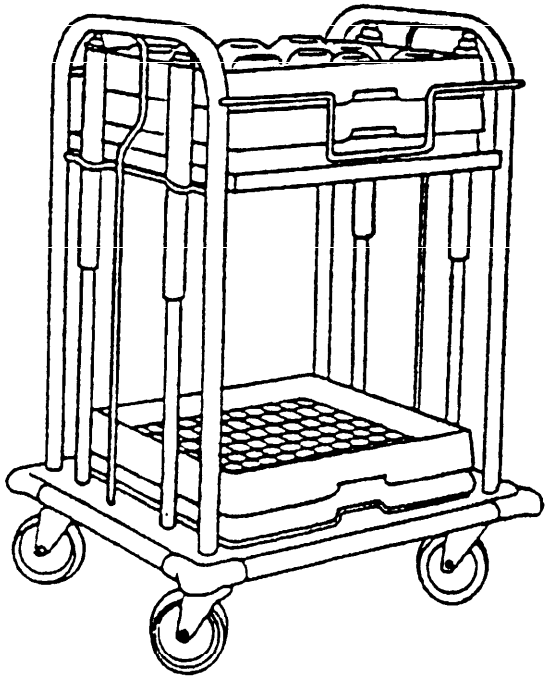


FIGURE 3. TYPE II, DESIGN B

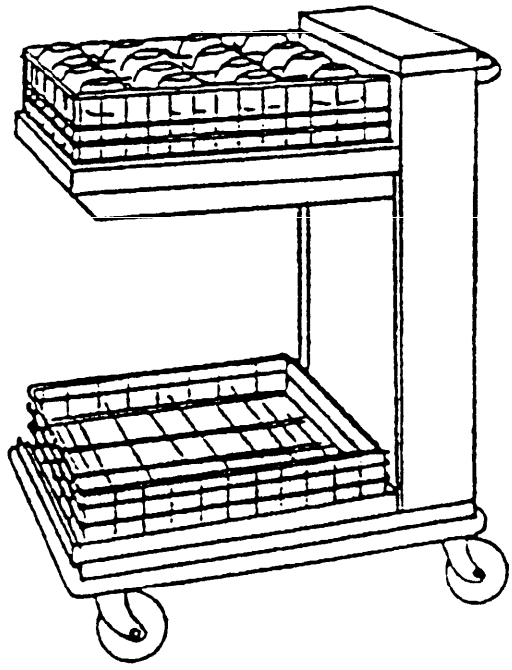


FIGURE 4. TYPE II, DESIGN C

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

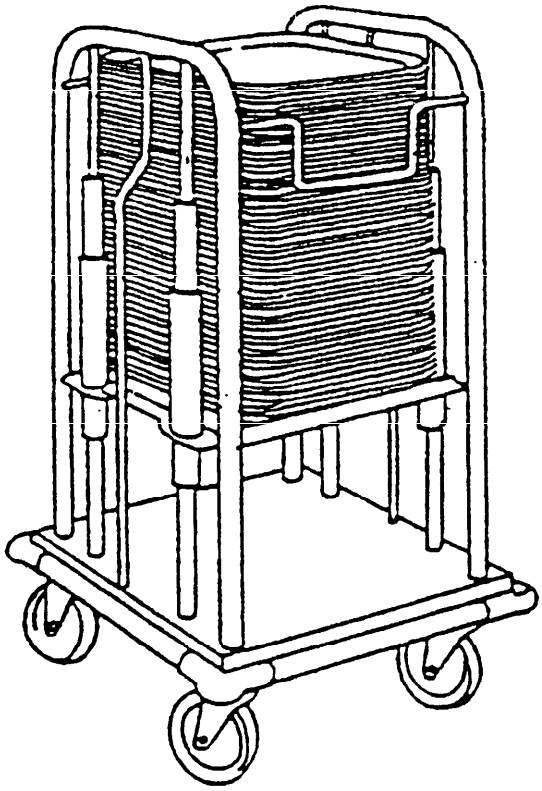


FIGURE 5. TYPE III, DESIGN B

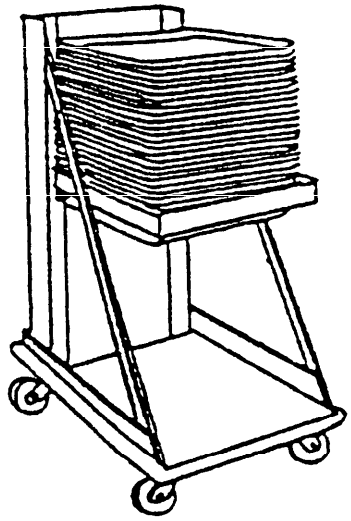


FIGURE 6. TYPE III, DESIGN C

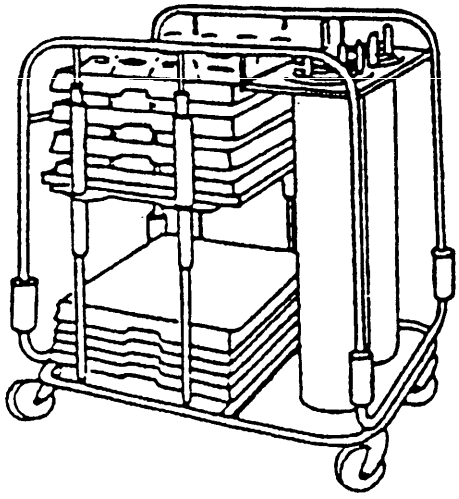


FIGURE 7. TYPE IV, DESIGN B

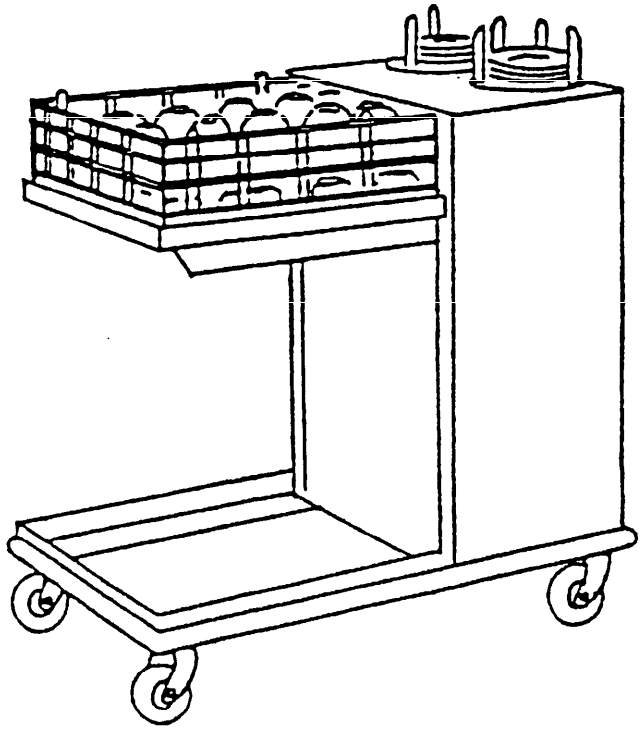


FIGURE 8. TYPE IV, DESIGN D

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.